

Brett Powell

Senior Software Engineering Manager

EMAIL

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LINKEDIN

www.linkedin.com/in/brett-powell

CORE SKILLS

LANGUAGES

Python, Bash · familiar with SQL, Go, Node.js, React, Ruby & Rails

CLOUD & PLATFORM

AWS & GCP, monolithic and distributed architectures, microservices, MySQL/Postgres

LEADERSHIP

Team building, growth roadmapping, stakeholder alignment, mediation, and problem solving. Practice grounded in Lencioni's Five Dysfunctions of a Team, The Phoenix Project, and Speed of Trust.

DELIVERY

Scrum & SRE practice, 90%+ delivery predictability, on-call reliability, cost reduction.

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional
2025 – 2027

Google Cloud – Professional Data Engineer

Google Cloud – Professional Cloud Architect

SUMMARY

Engineering leader with 8+ years building and running infrastructure, platform, and data teams. I drive reliable delivery by standardizing intake, setting clear stakeholder expectations, and protecting the team's focus while investing heavily in each engineer's growth and staying hands-on across Kubernetes, AWS, and CI/CD. Most recently I used AI to accelerate delivery and expand scope while cutting AWS spend 30%+ year over year.

EXPERIENCE

Sr. Manager, Software Engineering

JUL 2025 – PRESENT

Dealerware

- Drove stability to the Data & Reporting team by standardizing intake, setting clear stakeholder expectations, and saying "not right now" to work off the company's highest goals, producing constant velocity and reliable delivery.
- Used AI to accelerate delivery and expand the Infrastructure team's scope into internal tooling, building in-house over buying to cut costs while letting stakeholders extend the tools themselves.
- Reduced AWS spend 30%+ year over year, kept technical debt in check, and expanded platform stability to support the increased delivery speed AI enabled.

Infrastructure Engineering Manager

SEP 2022 – JUL 2025

Dealerware

- Operated as acting Product Owner, Scrum Master, and Architect while managing the team; maintained 90%+ delivery predictability without sacrificing on-call resolution.
- Built a unique growth roadmap for each engineer and stayed hands-on across EKS, IAM, AWS networking, microservice architecture, MySQL, and Postgres.
- Owned infrastructure roadmapping – balancing cost reduction, security updates, technical debt, and platform growth, reducing AWS spend 15% and helping shape DevOps/SRE culture.

DevOps Engineer IV

FEB 2022 – SEP 2022

Dealerware

- Led platform design and created Terraform and CI/CD templating for golden-path implementations; optimized pipelines and simplified EKS networking.
- Implemented Datadog monitoring and alerting and drove decoupling of the monolith into a message-flow architecture.

Software Engineer II

OCT 2019 – JAN 2022

ClearDATA

- Built decoupled Python FastAPI services deployed to GKE, plus internal APIs and CI/CD workflows used across the product.
- Wrote Open Policy Agent rego policies, contributed to the Forseti Real-Time Enforcer, and advised on GCP security and documentation.

Cloud System Admin → DevOps Engineer

SEP 2017 – OCT 2019

ClearDATA

- Helped establish the DevOps and Professional Services teams; automated internal and external solutions with Python, Node.js, and Go on AWS.
- Built automated Kubernetes upgrades using AWS Step Functions, Lambda, and SSM, and led projects that cut manual operations cost.